STORY 9 New Words • The Girl Who Became the Moon

1 **party** [ˈpɑːti] *n.* — вечеринка, праздник
A time when people meet to eat, dance and have fun.
→ The village had a party in the big house.

2 **guest** [gest] *n.* — гость
A person who comes to your house or your party.
→ She went there with the other guests.

3 **dance** [dɑːns] *v.* — танцевать
To move your body to music.
→ People ate, and people danced.

4 **hair** [heə] *n.* — волосы
The thing that grows on your head.
→ Malina washed her hair.

5 **grab** [græb] *v.* — схватить
To take something suddenly and strongly.
→ A hand grabbed Malina's hair.

6 **tear** [teə] *v.* — рвать
To pull something into pieces.
→ It tore her clothes.

7 **jewel** [ˈdʒuːəl] *n.* — драгоценный камень
A small beautiful stone that costs a lot.
→ She put small white jewels in her hair.

8 **dirt** [dɜːt] *n.* — грязь, сажа
Black or brown stuff that makes things not clean.
→ Malina had put black dirt in her hair.

9 **torch** [tɔːtʃ] *n.* — факел
A burning stick that people carry for light.
→ He took a torch from the wall.

10 **chase** [tʃeɪs] *v.* — гнаться, преследовать
To run after somebody to catch them.
→ He is chasing her across the sky.

11 **sky** [skaɪ] *n.* — небо
The space above us where the sun and the moon are.
→ He is chasing her across the sky.

12 **ground** [graʊnd] *n.* — земля
The land under our feet.
→ They ran so far that they left the ground.

Useful phrases from the story

turn off the lights — выключить свет
Then somebody turned off all the lights.

run after — бежать за кем-то
Malina took a torch and ran after him.

The Girl Who Became the Moon

In the far north the winter night is months long. The people there live a lot of their lives in the dark. This story comes from those people. It is about a brother and a sister.

The sister was called Malina. She was kind, and she worked hard, and everybody in the village liked her. Her brother Anningan was not kind at all.

One winter the village had a **party** in the big house. Malina washed her **hair** and put on her best clothes. She went there with the other **guests**.

For a long time it was a good night. People ate, and people **danced**, and the fire was warm. Then somebody turned off all the lights.

In the dark a hand **grabbed** Malina's hair. It pulled her head back. It **tore** her clothes. She could not see anything at all. She pushed the man away and ran out into the snow.

She sat outside for a long time. She was angry, but she was more than angry. There were forty people in that house. One of them had done it. She did not know which one. She told nobody, not even her mother.

A month later the village had another party.

This time Malina spent all day on her hair. She washed it and dried it by the fire. She put small white **jewels** in it, and the jewels shone in the firelight. When she walked into the big house, every person there turned round to look at her, and even Anningan said that she looked well.

People ate, and people danced. Then somebody turned off all the lights. In the dark a hand came out and grabbed her hair again.

Malina did not shout this time. She stood still and let him hold her, and she counted to ten inside her head. Then she pulled away and called for the lights.

Somebody lit the fire again. The room came back. Everybody was looking at everybody. "Show me your hands," said Malina.

Nobody understood her, but people held up their hands. Forty pairs of hands, and every one of them clean. Then she saw the last pair.

Under the white jewels, in her clean, beautiful hair, Malina had put black **dirt** from the bottom of the fire. Her brother stood by the wall. There was black **dirt** on his hand and on his fingers.

Anningan looked at his hand. Then he looked at his sister. Then he ran. He took a **torch** from the wall and ran out into the snow. Malina took a torch and ran after him. Two torches went out across the snow.

The guests came out of the big house and watched them go. They ran out onto the white land, and they ran all night.

They ran so far that they left the ground. They were still running. As they went up, they grew, and the two small lights became very big. Malina's torch went out. His did not.

So her brother is the sun. He is still burning. She is the moon, and she has no fire of her own.

He is **chasing** her across the **sky** tonight, and tomorrow night, and for ever. And when you see the moon in the daytime, thin and white and quiet, he is very close behind her.

